

REVENUE CYCLE BRIEFING • 2026

Why 14% of Medical Claims Get Denied on First Submission

And the exact 4-step protocol leading specialty practices and surgery centers use to lock in a 99.1% clean pass rate.

99.1%

Clean Claim Rate

<32

Days in A/R

10,600+

Payer EDI Rules

THE BOTTLENECK

Payers Have Weaponized Automated Denial Engines

Commercial payers and Medicare Advantage plans no longer use manual examiners to review initial claims. They deploy algorithmic front-end filters designed to reject claims for micro-discrepancies.

\$118,000

Average Annual Lost Revenue per Full-Time Physician

Trapped in unworked denials, write-offs, and expired timely filing windows due to billing team fatigue. (Source: HFMA & MGMA Practice Benchmarks)

65% of Denied Claims Are Never Resubmitted

Internal teams spend over 40% of their day on basic charge entry and hold times, leaving complex overturns and appeals completely untouched.

CLAIM AUDIT FINDINGS

The 3 Errors Driving 78% of Avoidable Claim Rejections

01 Inverted Modifiers & Procedural Unbundling

Improperly using Modifier 59 instead of distinct procedural modifiers (XE, XP, XS, XU) or failing to append Modifier 25 with clear E/M documentation separation.

02 Stale Eligibility & Benefit Coordination

Secondary crossover claims submitted with outdated copay/deductible accumulators or mismatched policyholder IDs, triggering instant CO-22 / CO-27 denials.

03 Missing NDC Unit Qualifiers on Specialty Drugs

Failing to convert 10-digit NDC packaging to mandatory 11-digit format with exact unit measurement qualifiers (UN, ML, GR, F2) on high-cost injectables.

THE AETHERA PROTOCOL

How We Achieve a 99.1% Clean-Claim Pass Rate

✓ **Step 1: Pre-Submission 277CA Scrubbing**

Every claim is scrubbed against 10,600+ payer EDI specifications, NCCI PTP edits, and MUE thresholds before file transmission.

✓ **Step 2: Sub-Specialty Certified Coders**

Complex operative and diagnostic charts are reviewed by AAPC/AHIMA certified coders who specialize strictly in your medical domain.

✓ **Step 3: Real-Time Timely Filing Watchdog**

Automated countdown monitors prevent claims from quietly expiring past aggressive 45-day commercial filing windows.

✓ **Step 4: Algorithmic Root-Cause Overturn Dossiers**

Pattern-level appeal packages overturn CARC 16, CO-45, and PR-204 rejections within 72 hours of remittance.

TAKE ACTION

Stop Leaving 7% to 14% of Reimbursement on the Table

NO COST • ZERO COMMITMENT

Free 50-Claim Denial Recovery Pilot

Submit 50 of your recent denied or aging claims. Our senior certified auditors will scrub them, identify root causes, and present an itemized cash-recovery plan.

- 100% HIPAA Compliant & BAA Protected
- Receive your detailed audit findings within 5 business days

How to get started:

Run Instant Claim Tools
aetherahealthcare.com/tools



Book an Executive Strategy Call
aetherahealthcare.com/schedule



Request Pilot via Email
aetherahealthcare.com/contact

